MWCF: what tomorrow's call is for, and what the folder shows

1. The meeting

A sub-committee of the board (organiser Máiréad O'Donnell; you, John Lawler the Chairman and others). Review: the Data and Competition Map and the ambitions for what the service would look like. Outcomes sought: pins on the map for outreach locations, a possible pilot location, and interim and long-term location ideas (an area, not a building). Objective: a location strategy and implementation plan covering the outreach locations and the central hub, interim and long term. **Máiréad's map has not reached your Gmail; I emailed her tonight asking for it.**

2. What John Lawler's "Building" folder holds (the San Marino project, Dooradoyle Road)

- **Pre-planning record, Limerick City and County Council, ref 1044365, 7 Nov 2025** (meeting 6 Nov 2025; attendees include Hugh Kelly of Reddy A+U, John Lawlor and Annmarie Gilmartin). Site: San Marino, Dooradoyle Road, about 1,030 sqm; demolition of a single-storey dwelling and a new support centre. **Zoning:** existing residential; health centre use is generally permitted; acceptable in principle; needs a planning statement with a robust justification. **Parking:** council says off-site parking cannot be enforced and wants some parking inside the site boundary; suggests a part two-storey design, with care for the neighbour to the north (high-level opaque windows, visual impact and daylight checks). **Access:** pedestrian and cycle only from Dooradoyle Road; vehicle access possibly from the south through Birch Grove, subject to sightlines and consent as the estate is in council charge. **Contributions:** 40 euro a sqm under the 2025 scheme unless the applicant is a voluntary, not-for-profit organisation.
- **Planning action tracker (20 Oct 2025):** design team being appointed (architect, engineers, QS and others); parking letters being sought, including from a rugby club for 20 spaces on weekdays and from a shopping centre whose owners are in Dublin; Uisce Éireann feasibility has a 16 week lead time; many reports "in progress".
- **Building survey (Feb 2025), planning-document list and an architect's presentation** (Reddy A+U, site plans and two ground and first floor options, dated 2026). Their text was partly unreadable to me.
- I did not read every page. Treat this as a summary of the main files.

3. What it means for tomorrow

- **This looks like one location option already worked up** (San Marino) with real planning detail. Tomorrow's call seems to be widening that into a strategy across outreach locations, a hub and a pilot site.
- **Key risk on San Marino:** parking inside the site, and the vehicle access through Birch Grove. These could decide whether the site works.
- **Cost note:** the contribution is waived for a voluntary not-for-profit; confirm MWCF qualifies.
- **Earlier mentions in your records:** the Chairman wanted to talk to the Mayor about council offices in Dooradoyle as a possible location, and referred to Rooney Auctioneers. These are ideas, not decisions.

4. Questions you could ask

- What are the selection criteria for the hub and for a pilot site (access, parking, cost, proximity to UHL)?
- Is San Marino still the lead option, and what happens if parking or access fails?
- What does the Data and Competition Map show about where people live and where other support already exists?
- What is the timetable and budget for the interim location, and who owns the implementation plan?

Limits: I could not read the map, the full presentation or the survey. I have not verified the planning details beyond the council's own record. I have shared nothing from the folder with anyone.